In this workshop you will invent an idea for an application in a small team and specify how that idea could be translated into a software product. You will use a series of techniques and frameworks that will help communicate how the components of a project make up the product:

1. Your team will specify their idea using the design thinking process.
2. Your team will translate your idea into 'epics' and 'user stories' before prioritising these features using the MoSCoW matrix.
3. Your team will propose a version release cycle and suggest what features should be released in which version of the software.
4. Finally your team will present a 30 second elevator pitch about your idea.

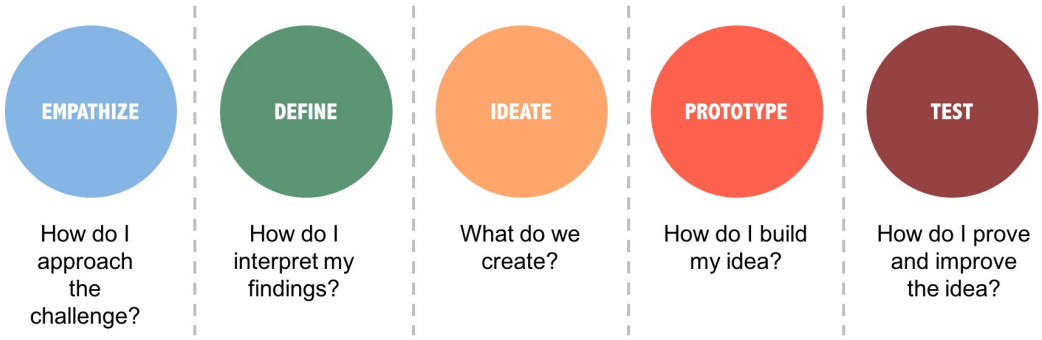
The term *MoSCoW* itself is an acronym derived from the first letter of each of four prioritization categories: M - *Must have*, S - *Should have*, C - *Could have*, W - *Won't have*.

Together this process will help guide you through the process of populating a backlog with prioritised features and tasks that are associated with 'epics' and 'user stories', prioritised with a numbering and colour coded system, annotated with workload estimations and ready to be tagged with people who are implementing the tasks during an agile development cycle.
The project you will consider is the specification from project 2026 - Project specification (page 2 for Requirements) - remember be creative and try to distinguish your solution from others.

1. Design thinking - 15 minutes

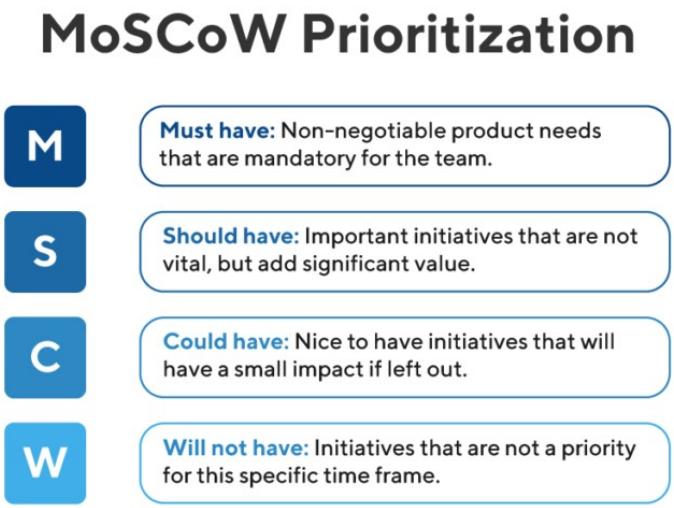
Design thinking is an approach to help build and define ideas and solutions. As a team address each of the questions in the graphic below.

- Start by considering 'why?'; why is this idea needed and important?
- Give time for brain storming and no bad ideas
- Design the system diagram and interface designs as free form as possible to give insight into the vision rather than the technology
- Conclude with how will this idea be evaluated at different levels [see week 2 roundup for extra content on linking a testing strategy to requirements]?



2. Prioritise your epics and user stories using the MoSCoW matrix - 15 minutes

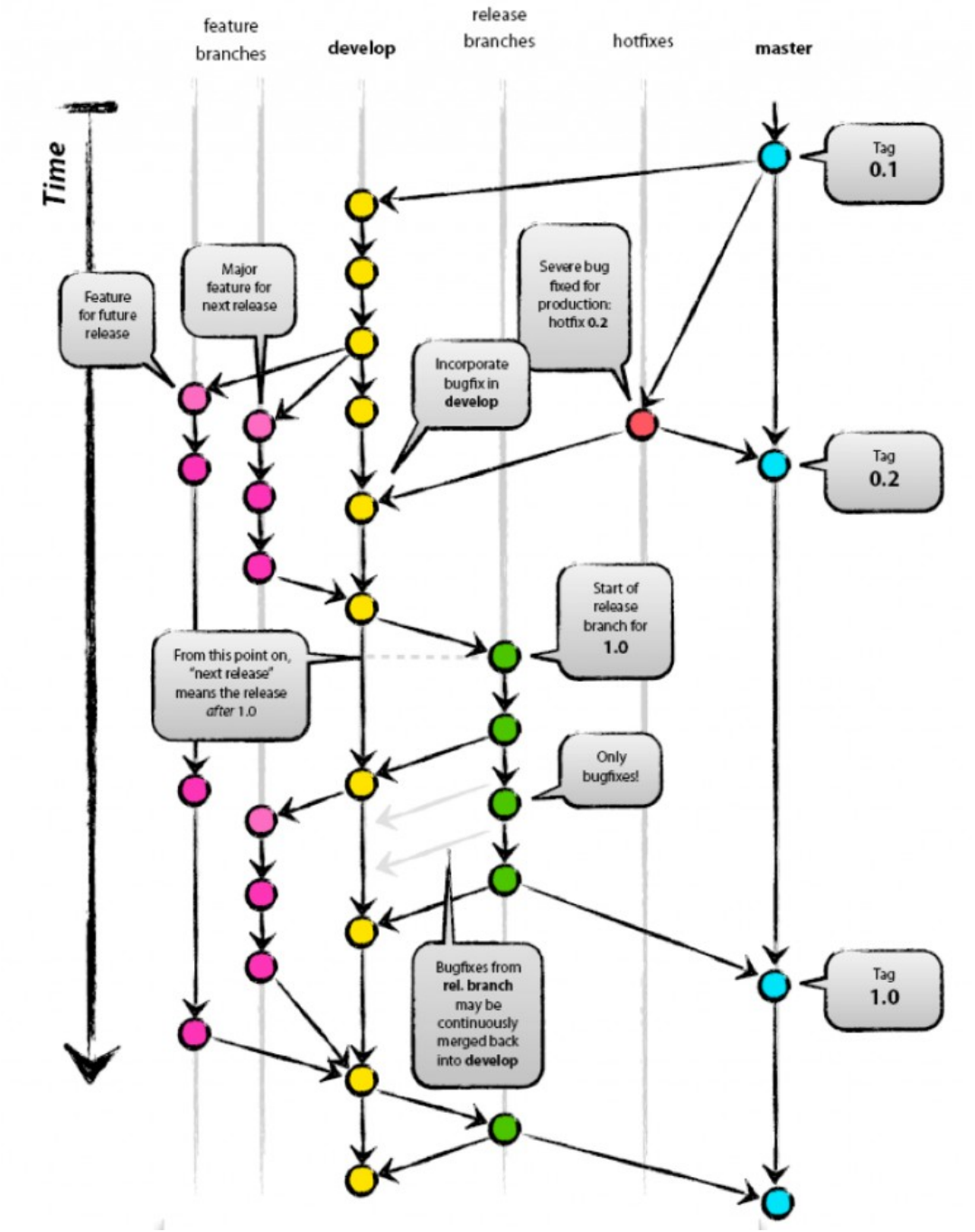
Next translate your idea into features. Consider what components will be needed to make your system work, defining each design feature based on not only functionality but what will distinguish this system from other existing systems. Once you have a list of the component features (or 'epics') capture their use in 'user stories'. These are minimal descriptions of a process to achieve something, they should combine a clear context and goal. Finally, once you have all the user stories and features, use the headings below from the MoSCoW matrix to prioritise the features.



3. Define the version release cycle plan - 15 minutes

In the next stage your team will consider a version release plan, i.e. how the features of your project will be built iteratively. Note, the diagram below shows hotfixes and a develop branch that may be part of your project implementation but aren't part of a version release plan. Include a column for each feature defined in the previous section and annotate how features will be combined to create versions as well as how functionality of those features will incrementally be improved and revisited as the versions increase.

This can be done with a graphical tool like draw.io with directional arrows and superimposed text annotations or in excel and structured like a gantt chart with each feature being a row and the versions being annotated as headings for each column.



4. The elevator pitch: sell, sell, sell - 5 minutes

Finally, nominate someone from your team to deliver an elevator pitch. They will have 30 seconds to grab the interest of a potential client. Make sure you articulate 'why' your idea is needed and how it will be delivered successfully.

By the end of this workshop you should have a tried a series of techniques that help translate an idea into a project plan that can be used to populate the backlog of an agile board. Additionally if you combine the resulting documents with a a thorough research section on requirements you will have a comprehensive inception report capturing the project plan that can be fed back to the stakeholders and a solid foundation for a group project.

◄ Lecture 1

Jump to...

Team allocatio

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